



**DATE:** September 6, 2024

**TO:** Daisy Catague, Interim Deputy Superintendent

**FROM:** Jon Jainga, Manager<sup>3</sup>, Community Services Branch  
Emergency Management | Park Rangers | Activation

**CC:** Markeith Blackshire, Director Parks and Environment

**SUBJECT:** DRAFT - ACO Data Tracking, MOA Review and Proposed Options

#### Background:

The Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) was made and agreed between Seattle Parks and Recreation (SPR) and the Department of Finance and Administrative Services (FAS), representing its Seattle Animal Shelter. The agreement supports the work of the 'Making Parks Safer' initiative. The current agreement expires on December 31, 2027. The agreement is funded by SPR and the Park District, for three (3) Animal Control Officers II positions employed by Seattle Animal Shelter. The Animal Control Officers work in a team with a SPR Facilities Maintenance Worker. [Note, the current FMW position have accepted a Park Ranger position in 2023]. There is no current FMW working with the Animal Control Officers. The team's work program is to educate the public and enforce - leash and scoop laws at SPR park locations, especially those locations with a history of complaints, violations and impacts to users and/or natural resources based on park users' non-compliance with these laws. [Note: since 2023 Park Rangers have been educating the public on the Park Codes and Rules, including the leash, animals running at large, and the scoop laws at the parks during their scheduled routes]. Below is a comparison of the 2023 & 2024 Data Tracking from both FAS and SPR.

#### Animal Control Data Tracking 2023 & 2024

##### FAS - Animal Control Officer Data Tracking

| ACO Overview | Verbal Warnings | Written Warnings | Written Citations | Park Exclusions |
|--------------|-----------------|------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| 2023 Totals  | 880             | 2                | 42 = \$2,652      | 0               |
| 2024 Totals  | 586             | 2                | 28 = \$1,704      | 0               |

##### Seattle Park Ranger Data Tracking

| 2023 Park Rangers<br>(June-Dec)   | Verbal Warnings | Written Warnings | Written Citations | Park Exclusions |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
|                                   | 307             | 4                | 0                 | 0               |
| 2024 Park Rangers<br>(Jan-August) | 366             | 3                | 1                 | 0               |

## Proposed Option #1 & Option #2

Below is a detailed narrative outlining two options moving forward utilizing the new re-established Seattle Park Ranger program. Option #1 would demonstrate a cost savings of \$151,550 and Option #2 would demonstrate a cost savings of \$303,101

### REVISED MOA: Option #1

**Option #1 Proposal: PDQ the Security Services vacant FMW Position, Position #1005453 Job Code 91507 to a Park Ranger Position Job Code # 51007 Union Code 019 = 1 FTE**

#### Summary Proposal:

##### Option#1

- **2025 Reduce MOA to 2 ACO II FTE and 1 SPR PR**
- **2025 MOA estimate value \$303,102 (2023 Cost) [NOTE: 2025 Cost Savings of \$151,550]**
- **2025 Scope of Work – focus on SPR Athletic Fields with scheduled league play**
- **2025 Continue with Documentation and Reporting in the Data Tracking App.**
- **2025 Term of Agreement through December 31, 2025, revised to a one-year contract.**
- **Continue to monitor and review by October 31, 2025**

## 1. PURPOSE

This Memorandum of Agreement ("Agreement") is made by and between Seattle Parks and Recreation ("SPR") and the Department of Finance and Administrative Services ("FAS"), representing its Seattle Animal Shelter ("SAS"). This agreement supports the work of the Making Parks Safer initiative, one of the component elements of the broader Maintaining Parks and Facilities initiative funded by the Seattle Park District ("Park District"). The agreement addresses scope of work, schedule and conditions of work, reporting and compensation and billing.

This Agreement is for the funding by SPR and the Park District, of three ACO II ("ACO") positions employed by SAS. (The term "the ACO" encompasses the fact that more than one ACO may perform the work program defined here.) The ACO will work in a team with a Seattle Park Ranger Facilities-Maintenance Worker ("FMW") employed by SPR. **The team's work program is to educate the public and enforce - leash and scoop laws at SPR park locations, especially those locations with a history of complaints, violations and impacts to users and/or natural resources based on park users' non-compliance with these laws. [Note: Park Rangers have been educating the public at the parks during their scheduled routes].**

## 2. SCOPE OF WORK

While working as a team, the ACO and a **Park Ranger FMW** will seek to educate park users and promote compliance with all applicable animal-control laws in SPR parks. Enforcement of these laws is within the purview of SAS, and the ACO will have the discretionary authority to issue citations for non-compliance. It is anticipated, however, that the work program will be primarily educational and that park users' observation of the ACO/**Park Ranger FMW** team will have a deterrent effect in terms of non-compliance. The **Park Ranger FMW** may also carry out identified or ad-hoc service and/or maintenance tasks will also identify any park maintenance service needs and call the SPR Dispatcher to create a WO for the

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maintenance task in the parks; enforce the City Park Code; provide basic customer service to park users; collect information about park use, conditions, and more complex service and/or maintenance needs; and other duties as assigned; and enter their completed tasks into the Park Ranger Data Tracking App. The ACO may also carry out FAS/SAS identified, or ad hoc service tasks as assigned by the SAS leadership team; and other duties as assigned. SPR and FAS will establish guidelines by which they will create the team's work itineraries and the degree to which these itineraries will remain flexible, for instance to respond to emergent issues and/or complaints.

### 3. WORK SCHEDULE

The typical work schedule described in this Agreement will take place on a Wednesday through Saturday or Sunday through Wednesday schedule. Work hours will vary by season and programmatically, based on high-use times and to maximize the number of daylight hours the team can spend in parks. The typical hours will be 1000 to 2000 during daylight savings time and 0700 to 1700 when daylight savings ends. The team may also need to flex their hours to attend community meetings to discuss park-related topics.

The ACO and **Park Ranger FMW** will either report to or meet at the SAS and then depart for the day's planned itinerary or alternatively, by mutual agreement, at a SPR's maintenance facility in a location determined to suit the needs of the program. The **Park Ranger FMW** and ACO will share driving responsibilities of both FAS and SPR vehicles and each program team member shall have a key for the vehicle being used that day.

Repairs of damage to department vehicles will be the responsibility of the department of the driver when the damage occurred. The ACO and the **Park Ranger FMW** will spend most of their shift engaged in the work described in this Agreement, including the time spent to travel to and between parks and to return to either SAS or other designated location at the end of their shift. An exception will be for department or program required trainings, meetings and other designated events.

### 4. CONDITIONS OF WORK

While in a park, the **Park Ranger FMW** and ACO will always maintain radio communication with each other with an emphasis to always keep a line-of-sight contact and be ready to move into close physical proximity should an interaction with a park user become charged. The **Park Ranger FMW** and the ACO should view themselves as a team, working together and communicating with each other to address issues of concern to both SPR and FAS. The ACO shall be responsible for organizing the daily patrol area and route based on complaints received by SAS. Other duties performed by this team shall be shared. SAS will process and hold all law enforcement agency copies of citations issued by ACOs for the required retention period. SPR will process and hold all law enforcement agency copies of citations issued by the **Park Ranger FMWs** for the required retention period. SPR will be responsible for supplying the **Park Ranger FMW** with a citation book from SPD. SPR will provide a copy of citations issued for leash law violations by the **Park Ranger FMW** to SAS for recording in the SAS database. The ACO will carry barrier equipment, which may be used as a tool or barrier to push away an aggressive animal. The **Park Ranger FMW** will carry similar protective equipment. The ACO and **Park Ranger FMW** will both carry cell phones as well as any other equipment mutually agreed to by SPR and FAS.

### 5. DOCUMENTATION AND REPORTING

SPR will provide the **Park Ranger FMW** with the electronic equipment needed to record the origin and

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type of interaction with a member of the public, the infraction observed, and the result of the interaction. (E.g., patrol and incident; scoop violation; warning). SPR will also collect data on the location and time of each interaction and on each visit by the team to a single park. SPR may also collect other points of data that reasonably relate to the work program and its goal of Making Parks Safer. If the electronic means to collect data are not available due to equipment unavailability or failure, SPR will provide The **Park Ranger** FMW will enter the data into the Park Ranger Data Tracking App. In that case, SPR will be responsible for transferring the data to the appropriate system and for returning the electronic equipment to use as soon as possible. SPR will share the data collected with FAS. The ACO and **Park Ranger** FMW shall record all contacts and citations in the SPR app on the Parks Code Violation Dashboard.

Within five working days of the end of each month, SPR will provide FAS a summary report on that month's data, which FAS will include with its invoice to SPR Accounting.

## 6. TERM OF AGREEMENT

The term of this Agreement shall begin when fully executed by all parties and shall end on **December 31, 2025, [Note: This should be up for review and discussion by December 31, 2024]**, unless amended by written agreement or terminated earlier.

## 7. BILLING AND PAYMENT

During the term of this Agreement, SPR will reimburse FAS for **160 240** hours/pay period (**2 3** FTEs ACO IIs \* 80 hours/pay period) at the applicable ACO II top hourly rate including Annual Wage Increases (AWI), and an additional 47.97% for all ACO employee benefits. Overtime is not included unless pre-authorized by SPR. The ACO will remain on the FAS payroll and code hours worked to a project code. Timesheets for the FMW will be approved by the SPR supervisor and timesheets for the ACO will be approved by the SAS Field Services Supervisor.

In addition, SPR will reimburse FAS program and supply costs of **\$6,000 \$9,000** (\$3,000 each \* **2 3** FTEs ACO II) and divisional overhead of **\$20,330 \$30,495** (\$10,165 each \* **2 3** FTEs ACO II).

| Year                                                 | Per FTE Cost     | Total Cost 2023<br>3 FTE ACO II | Option #1 Proposal<br>2 FTE ACO II |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Top 2022 hourly rate (2023 AWI still in negotiation) | \$44.79          | \$44.79                         | \$44.79                            |
| Salaries                                             | \$93,522         | \$280,565                       | \$184,044                          |
| Benefits (47.97%)                                    | \$44,864         | \$134,592                       | \$89,728                           |
| Total Salaries & Benefits                            | \$138,386        | \$415,157                       | \$276,772                          |
| Supplies                                             | \$3,000          | \$9,000                         | \$6,000                            |
| Divisional indirect                                  | \$10,165         | \$30,495                        | \$20,330                           |
| Total billing                                        | <b>\$151,551</b> | \$454,652                       | \$303,102                          |

**[NOTE: 2025 Cost Savings of \$151,550]**

FAS will submit monthly requests for payment to SPR via a pre-established interdepartmental journal entry set up where FAS's expenses, along with a calculation spreadsheet of these costs will be charged to

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SPR's PS 9.2 activity code.

| <b>Paying Department</b> | <b>Billing Department</b> |
|--------------------------|---------------------------|
| Project: PRF1602         | Project: FA4MSSASENF      |
| Activity: OPS            | Activity: PARKS           |
| Org: FAI01               | Org: FAI01                |
| Fund: 10200              | Fund: 00100               |
| PCBU: PRO                | PCBU: FA4                 |
| Account: 541900          | Account: 360750           |

#### **8. ASSIGNMENT**

This Agreement shall not be assigned in whole or in part by either party without the prior written approval of the other party.

#### **9. COMPLIANCE WITH LAW**

The parties to this agreement shall comply with all federal, state, and local laws and ordinances.

#### **10. ENTIRE AGREEMENT**

This Agreement constitutes the complete contractual agreement of the parties, and any oral representations or understandings not incorporated herein are excluded.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, in consideration of the terms, conditions, and covenants contained herein, or attached and incorporated and made a part hereof, the parties have executed this Agreement by having their representatives affix their signatures below.

**SEATTLE PARKS AND RECREATION**

**FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICES**

**Superintendent:**

**Director:**

**REVISED MOA: Option #2**

**Option #2 Proposal: PDQ the Security Services vacant FMW Position, Position #1005453 Job Code 91507 to a Park Ranger Position Job Code # 51007 Union Code 019 = 1 FTE**

**Summary Proposal:****Option#2**

- **2025 Reduce MOA to 1 ACO II FTE and 1 SPR PR**
- **2025 MOA estimate value \$151,551 (2023 Cost) [NOTE: 2025 Cost Savings of \$303,101]**
- **2025 Scope of Work – focus on SPR Athletic Fields with scheduled league play**
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#### 17. BILLING AND PAYMENT

During the term of this Agreement, SPR will reimburse FAS for **80 240** hours/pay period (**1 3** FTEs ACO IIs \* 80 hours/pay period) at the applicable ACO II top hourly rate including Annual Wage Increases (AWI), and an additional 47.97% for all ACO employee benefits. Overtime is not included unless pre-authorized by SPR. The ACO will remain on the FAS payroll and code hours worked to a project code. Timesheets for the FMW will be approved by the SPR supervisor and timesheets for the ACO will be approved by the SAS Field Services Supervisor.

In addition, SPR will reimburse FAS program and supply costs of **\$3,000 \$9,000** (\$3,000 each \* **1 3** FTE ACO II) and divisional **overhead of \$10,165 \$30,495** (\$10,165 each \* **1 3** FTE ACO II).

| Year                                                 | Per FTE Cost | Total Cost 2023<br>3 FTE ACO II | Option #2 Proposal<br>1 FTE ACO II |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Top 2022 hourly rate (2023 AWI still in negotiation) | \$44.79      | \$44.79                         | \$44.79                            |
| Salaries                                             | \$93,522     | \$280,565                       | \$93,522                           |
| Benefits (47.97%)                                    | \$44,864     | \$134,592                       | \$44,864                           |
| Total Salaries & Benefits                            | \$138,386    | \$415,157                       | 138,386                            |
| Supplies                                             | \$3,000      | \$9,000                         | \$3,000                            |
| Divisional indirect                                  | \$10,165     | \$30,495                        | \$10,165                           |
| Total billing                                        | \$151,551    | \$454,652                       | \$151,551                          |

**[NOTE: 2025 Cost Savings of \$303,101]**

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| <b>Paying Department</b> | <b>Billing Department</b> |
|--------------------------|---------------------------|
| Project: PRF1602         | Project: FA4MSSASENF      |
| Activity: OPS            | Activity: PARKS           |
| Org: FAI01               | Org: FAI01                |
| Fund: 10200              | Fund: 00100               |
| PCBU: PRO                | PCBU: FA4                 |
| Account: 541900          | Account: 360750           |

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**SEATTLE PARKS AND RECREATION**

Superintendent

**FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICES**

Director

